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AI to detect TB in bid to expedite visa process

ABU DHABI
BY ALI AL HAMMADI
Reporter

The Emirates Health Services Corporation has begun implementing artificial intelligence (AI) solutions in medical examination centres for residency, visa and identity procedures. This initiative aims to enhance the detection of pulmonary tuberculosis (TB) through general chest X-ray imaging.

By leveraging AI technology, the corporation enables the analysis of X-ray images in less than one minute, significantly reducing the time required for radiologists to approve final medical reports. The accuracy rate has risen from 80 to 98 per cent by 2024, underscoring the remarkable progress in AI-driven radiological analysis.

Medical fitness screening for residency visas remains a mandatory requirement for visa processing. This service enables expatriates to obtain a medical fitness certificate, confirming absence of infectious diseases such as pulmonary tuberculosis. The certificate is essential for obtaining or renewing a residency visa, which can be processed through designated medical screening centres and select public health facilities.

Ukraine backs US proposal for 30-day truce with Russia

US AGREES TO LIFT RESTRICTIONS ON MILITARY AID, INTELLIGENCE SHARING

JEDDAH

Ukraine yesterday backed a US proposal for a 30-day general ceasefire with Russia, with the United States in turn agreeing to lift restrictions on military aid and intelligence sharing, a joint statement said.

After talks in Saudi Arabia, the two sides also agreed to conclude "as soon as possible" a deal on Ukrainian minerals, the statement said.

"Ukraine expressed readiness to accept the US proposal to enact an immediate, interim 30-day ceasefire, which can be extended by mutual agreement of the parties, and which is subject to acceptance and concurrent implementation by the Russian Federation," a joint statement said after the talks.

"The United States will communicate to Russia that Russian reciprocity is the key to achieving peace," it added.

Big breakthrough

"The United States will immediately lift the pause on intelligence sharing and resume security assistance to Ukraine."

President Donald Trump had shut off aid after a disastrous meeting with his Ukrainian counterpart Volodymyr Zelensky on February 28.

Trump aide Mike Waltz said he



■ A resident stands in the courtyard of his house as smoke billows from a fire following Russian bombardment on the outskirts of Odessa in Ukraine yesterday.

will speak to Russia on the ceasefire proposal.

Earlier, Kyiv conducted its largest drone attack on Moscow in three years of war.

Kyiv officials said the "largest drone attack in history", in which hundreds of drones slammed into Moscow and other areas overnight, was intended to push Russian President Vladimir Putin to agree to an aerial and

naval ceasefire. "This is an additional signal to Putin that he should also be interested in a ceasefire in the air," said Andriy Kovalenko, a national security council official responsible for countering disinformation.

Three people were killed in the attack, which both sides said was the biggest so far on Moscow. Russia's army said it intercepted 337 drones around the country.

In retaliation, Russian strikes killed six people, including two children, in the eastern Ukraine region of Donetsk, the regional governor said yesterday.

"Two brothers aged 11 and 13 were killed," the regional governor Vadym Filashkin wrote on social media, adding that four more people had been killed that day and another seven were wounded. — AFP

MIDDLE EAST

Arab nations condemn Israel's move to cut Gaza's electricity | P10

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Pakistan's ambassador to Turkmenistan denied entry into US | P11



INDIA

13 of the world's 20 most polluted cities are in India | P12



IFTAR 18:30

Fajr	05:14	Shuruq	06:28
Dhuhr	12:31	Asr	15:54
Maghrib	18:30	Isha	19:43

IMSAK 05:04

Add 4 minutes for Abu Dhabi, deduct 4 minutes for RAK and 6 minutes for Fujairah

Trump says will double Canada steel, aluminium tariff rate to 50%

Threatens to shut down the automobile manufacturing business in Canada

WASHINGTON

US President Donald Trump announced massive new tariffs on Canadian steel and aluminium yesterday, while threatening to "shut down" its auto industry and saying the best way to end the trade war was for Washington's ally to be absorbed into the United States.

Trump's shock new threats came hours before a midnight deadline for ramping up the Republican's increasingly global trade offensive. On his Truth Social platform, Trump announced that he would increase



■ Donald Trump

tariffs on Canadian steel and aluminium imports by an additional 25 per cent for a total of 50 per cent duties on those commodities for the neighbour.

This is in addition to tariffs of 25 per cent on steel and aluminium imports from around

the world. The upcoming levies, which currently allow for no exceptions, threaten to hit everything from electronics to vehicles and construction equipment — and have manufacturers scrambling to find cost-effective domestic suppliers.

Defiant note

Canadian Prime Minister-elect Mark Carney said yesterday his incoming administration would hit back with "maximum impact in the US" against escalating tariffs on Canadian imports into the United States.

Trump said his new supercharged tariffs were in response to Canadian province Ontario's imposition of a 25-per cent tax on electricity exports to the United States. Trump added the "only thing which makes sense" is for Canada to join the United States as a 51st state. — AFP

SPORT

Mary Kom: Olympics will be a big boost for India | P14



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Associate Professor – Marketing & Deputy Director – Ethics, Sustainability & Social Responsibility (ESR)

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